

THOMPSON SUBMACHINE-GUN MODEL 1928

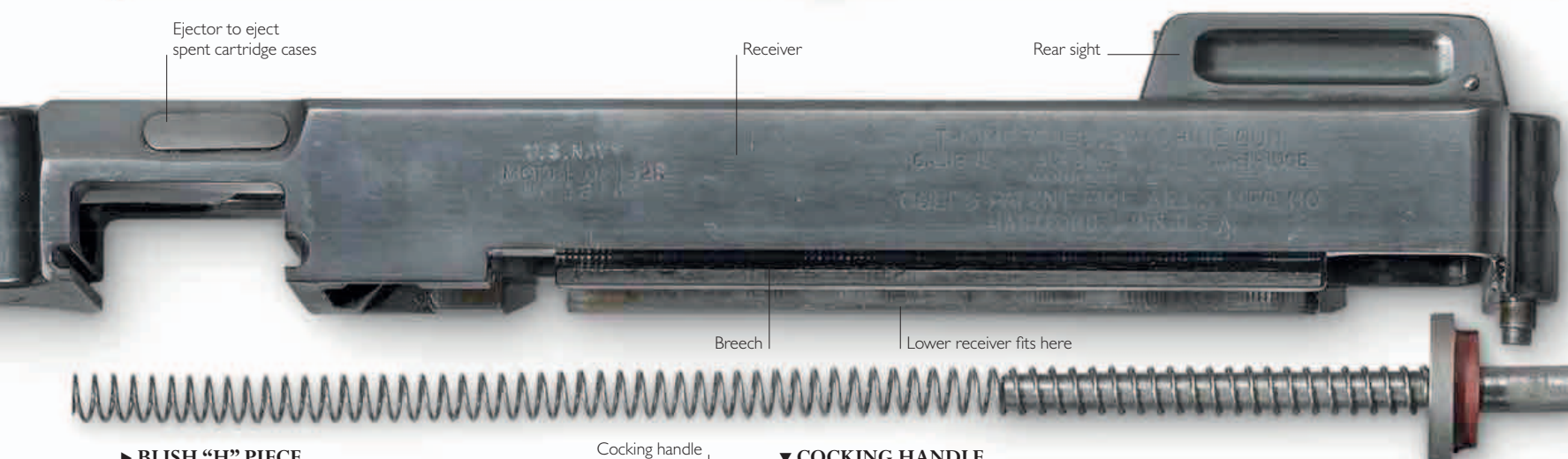
Date 1928

Origin US

Barrel 12in (30.5cm)

Caliber .45in ACP

This weapon was invented by John T. Thompson. Its success is attributed to its compactness and high rate of fire. This model was adopted by the US Navy in 1928 and was a slight upgrade of the Thompson M1921 (see p.210). The Model 1928 was fitted with a Cutts Compensator and a straight forestock, which replaced the forward pistol grip for US Navy use, although some units were also produced with the grip.



► BUSH "H" PIECE

The Bush "H" piece connects the cocking handle with the bolt. It prevents the bolt from moving backward before the bullet has left the gun. The pressure generated on firing a cartridge pushes the "H" piece downward, locking the bolt in position and closing the breech. When the pressure drops, the "H" piece slides back upward, allowing recoil force to push the bolt backward.



▼ COCKING HANDLE

To cock the gun for firing, the cocking handle is pulled backward, moving the bolt to the rear. When the trigger is pulled, the bolt moves forward, chambering and firing a cartridge.

▲ MAINSPRING

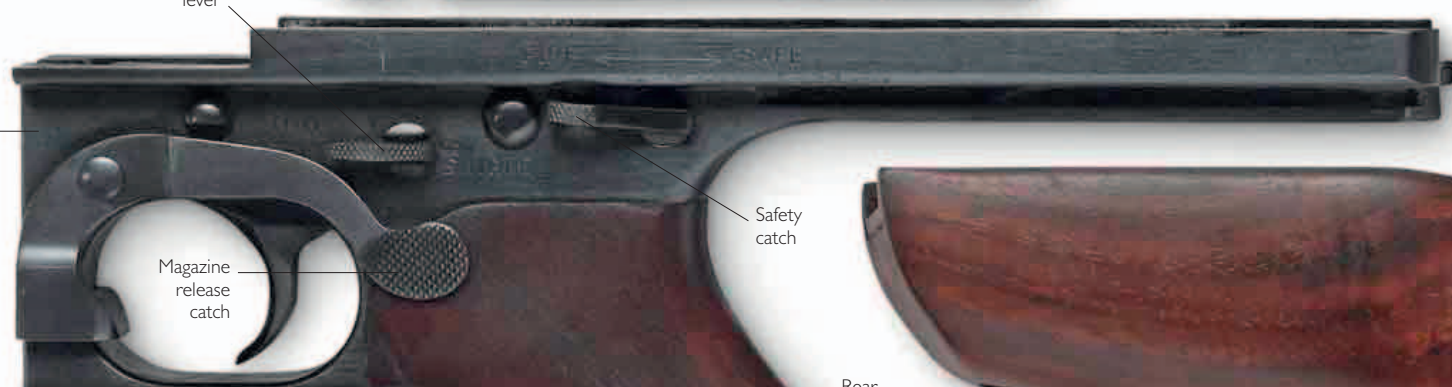
The recoil force generated by firing a cartridge pushes back the bolt, compressing this spring. It then springs forward, advancing the bolt and preparing the gun to fire the next round.

◀ BOLT

When firing in automatic mode, the bolt is locked and unlocked repeatedly, moving forward and backward. As a result, spent cartridge cases are continuously ejected from the ejection port and new ones are chambered from the magazine.



Magazine attaches here



► LOWER RECEIVER

Also known as the frame, the lower receiver houses the basic firing mechanism—the trigger, the fire selector lever, the safety catch, the housing in front of the trigger guard which the magazine slides into, and the magazine-release catch. A rearward extension has the fitting onto which the removable butt is attached. It also carries the rear pistol grip.

▲ REMOVABLE BUTT

To allow the gun to be made even more compact for ease of carrying, or for concealment, the user could easily detach the butt by depressing a catch and sliding it rearward.